Who is buying and why?

Explore five fictional practice cases. Open records in any order, make or revise a tentative match, then choose the evidence that supports your final match. No score or timer. Your choices last only while this page is open. B2B means a business buying from another business for an organisational purpose. B2C means an individual buying from a business for personal use. Product, price and pace alone do not define the sales structure. If you compare without choosing both an opened record and a sales structure: Open a record and select it as your evidence, then choose B2B or B2C before comparing your reasoning.

Case 1: A pair for the weekend

Jo purchases running shoes from a retailer. Which sales structure fits this purchase? Which sales structure fits this purchase? Make a tentative match: B2B (business to business), B2C (business to consumer), or not sure yet. Inspect the records in any order and revise your match as you learn more.

Buyer and use note

Jo buys the shoes for her own weekend runs.

Visit record

The shop visit is short.

Product record

The product is running shoes. Choose the record that best establishes the buyer and purpose, then match the transaction to B2B or B2C. Compare your reasoning below. There is no penalty for opening a less useful record. Buyer and use note + B2B: The buyer and use note establishes a person buying for personal use. Match this transaction to B2C, then compare your reasoning again. Buyer and use note + B2C: Jo is buying from a business for her own use. That makes this business-to-consumer. The short visit and type of product are not what define it. Visit record + B2B: This record describes the product, price, pace or purchase process. It does not establish whether the purchase is personal or organisational. Your sales structure might fit, but you need stronger evidence. Open the buyer and use note, then revise your evidence and match. Visit record + B2C: This record describes the product, price, pace or purchase process. It does not establish whether the purchase is personal or organisational. Your sales structure might fit, but you need stronger evidence. Open the buyer and use note, then revise your evidence and match. Product record + B2B: This record describes the product, price, pace or purchase process. It does not establish whether the purchase is personal or organisational. Your sales structure might fit, but you need stronger

evidence. Open the buyer and use note, then revise your evidence and match. Product record + B2C: This record describes the product, price, pace or purchase process. It does not establish whether the purchase is personal or organisational. Your sales structure might fit, but you need stronger evidence. Open the buyer and use note, then revise your evidence and match.

Evidence trail

Start with the buyer and use note: Jo is buying for herself. The visit record tells you about pace and the product record tells you what was bought; neither establishes the sales structure. In the next case, keep the shoes the same and inspect who buys them. Retry by choosing another record or sales structure. After the supported match, continue to the next case.

Case 2: The same shoes. A different buyer.

The retailer sells the same running shoes in a second transaction. Does the same sales structure still fit? Which sales structure fits this purchase? Make a tentative match: B2B (business to business), B2C (business to consumer), or not sure yet. Inspect the records in any order and revise your match as you learn more.

Buyer and use note

A gym company buys the shoes for its staff uniforms.

Product record

The product is the same running shoes as in the first case.

Order record

The order is placed online. Choose the record that best establishes the buyer and purpose, then match the transaction to B2B or B2C. Compare your reasoning below. There is no penalty for opening a less useful record. Buyer and use note + B2B: The gym company is buying from another business for an organisational purpose. The same shoes can be part of a B2B or B2C sale; the product and online ordering do not decide it. Buyer and use note + B2C: The buyer and use note establishes an organisation buying for its work. Match this transaction to B2B, then compare your reasoning again. Product record + B2B: This record describes the product, price, pace or purchase process. It does not establish whether the purchase is personal or organisational. Your sales structure might fit, but you need stronger evidence. Open the buyer and use note, then revise your evidence and match. Product record + B2C: This record describes the product, price, pace or purchase process. It does not establish whether the purchase is personal or organisational. Your sales structure might fit, but you need stronger evidence. Open the buyer and use note, then revise your evidence and match. Order

record + B2B: This record describes the product, price, pace or purchase process. It does not establish whether the purchase is personal or organisational. Your sales structure might fit, but you need stronger evidence. Open the buyer and use note, then revise your evidence and match. Order record + B2C: This record describes the product, price, pace or purchase process. It does not establish whether the purchase is personal or organisational. Your sales structure might fit, but you need stronger evidence. Open the buyer and use note, then revise your evidence and match.

Evidence trail

Compare this buyer and use note with case 1: the shoes are unchanged, but the buyer is now a company buying for staff. That changes the match from B2C to B2B. Product and ordering channel do not define the structure. Retry by choosing another record or sales structure. After the supported match, continue to the next case.

Case 3: A quick replacement order

A supplier receives an order for replacement cups. Which sales structure fits? Which sales structure fits this purchase? Make a tentative match: B2B (business to business), B2C (business to consumer), or not sure yet. Inspect the records in any order and revise your match as you learn more.

Buyer and use note

A café buys replacement cups from the supplier for use in its business.

Order record

The order takes only a few minutes.

Product record

The items are cups. Choose the record that best establishes the buyer and purpose, then match the transaction to B2B or B2C. Compare your reasoning below. There is no penalty for opening a less useful record. Buyer and use note + B2B: The café is a business buying supplies from another business. A quick transaction can still be B2B: speed does not change the buyer or purpose. Buyer and use note + B2C: The buyer and use note establishes an organisation buying for its work. Match this transaction to B2B, then compare your reasoning again. Order record + B2B: This record describes the product, price, pace or purchase process. It does not establish whether the purchase is personal or organisational. Your sales structure might fit, but you need stronger evidence. Open the buyer and use note, then revise your evidence and match. Order record + B2C: This record describes the product, price, pace or purchase process. It does not establish whether the purchase is personal or organisational. Your sales structure might fit, but you need stronger evidence. Open the buyer and use note,

then revise your evidence and match. Product record + B2B: This record describes the product, price, pace or purchase process. It does not establish whether the purchase is personal or organisational. Your sales structure might fit, but you need stronger evidence. Open the buyer and use note, then revise your evidence and match. Product record + B2C: This record describes the product, price, pace or purchase process. It does not establish whether the purchase is personal or organisational. Your sales structure might fit, but you need stronger evidence. Open the buyer and use note, then revise your evidence and match.

Evidence trail

The buyer and use note establishes a business purchasing for its operations. The order record is tempting because B2B purchases are often described as lengthy. This order is quick, yet still B2B. A typical pace is not a definition. Retry by choosing another record or sales structure. After the supported match, continue to the next case.

Case 4: A decision that takes weeks

Sam buys an expensive bicycle from a shop after comparing options for several weeks. Which sales structure fits? Which sales structure fits this purchase? Make a tentative match: B2B (business to business), B2C (business to consumer), or not sure yet. Inspect the records in any order and revise your match as you learn more.

Buyer and use note

Sam buys the bicycle for personal leisure.

Price record

The bicycle is expensive.

Comparison record

Sam spends several weeks comparing bicycles. Choose the record that best establishes the buyer and purpose, then match the transaction to B2B or B2C. Compare your reasoning below. There is no penalty for opening a less useful record. Buyer and use note + B2B: The buyer and use note establishes a person buying for personal use. Match this transaction to B2C, then compare your reasoning again. Buyer and use note + B2C: Sam is buying from a business for personal use. This is B2C even though it is expensive and takes time. Neither price nor delay makes the buyer an organisation. Price record + B2B: This record describes the product, price, pace or purchase process. It does not establish whether the purchase is personal or organisational. Your sales structure might fit, but you need stronger evidence. Open the buyer and use note, then revise your evidence and match. Price record + B2C: This record describes the product, price, pace or purchase process. It does not establish whether the purchase is personal

or organisational. Your sales structure might fit, but you need stronger evidence. Open the buyer and use note, then revise your evidence and match. Comparison record + B2B: This record describes the product, price, pace or purchase process. It does not establish whether the purchase is personal or organisational. Your sales structure might fit, but you need stronger evidence. Open the buyer and use note, then revise your evidence and match. Comparison record + B2C: This record describes the product, price, pace or purchase process. It does not establish whether the purchase is personal or organisational. Your sales structure might fit, but you need stronger evidence. Open the buyer and use note, then revise your evidence and match.

Evidence trail

The buyer and use note establishes personal leisure. The price and comparison records show a considered purchase, but neither turns Sam into an organisational buyer. A B2C purchase can take time. Retry by choosing another record or sales structure. After the supported match, continue to the next case.

Case 5: Software for the company

A vendor sells cloud software after several meetings. Which sales structure fits? Which sales structure fits this purchase? Make a tentative match: B2B (business to business), B2C (business to consumer), or not sure yet. Inspect the records in any order and revise your match as you learn more.

Buyer and use note

A company buys the software for its internal operations.

Product record

The product is cloud software.

Meeting record

Several meetings take place before the purchase. Choose the record that best establishes the buyer and purpose, then match the transaction to B2B or B2C. Compare your reasoning below. There is no penalty for opening a less useful record. Buyer and use note + B2B: An organisation is purchasing from a business to support its operations. The meetings fit this example, but the organisational purchase is the decisive evidence. Buyer and use note + B2C: The buyer and use note establishes an organisation buying for its work. Match this transaction to B2B, then compare your reasoning again. Product record + B2B: This record describes the product, price, pace or purchase process. It does not establish whether the purchase is personal or organisational. Your sales structure might fit, but you need stronger evidence. Open the buyer and use note, then revise your evidence and match. Product record + B2C: This

record describes the product, price, pace or purchase process. It does not establish whether the purchase is personal or organisational. Your sales structure might fit, but you need stronger evidence. Open the buyer and use note, then revise your evidence and match. Meeting record + B2B: This record describes the product, price, pace or purchase process. It does not establish whether the purchase is personal or organisational. Your sales structure might fit, but you need stronger evidence. Open the buyer and use note, then revise your evidence and match. Meeting record + B2C: This record describes the product, price, pace or purchase process. It does not establish whether the purchase is personal or organisational. Your sales structure might fit, but you need stronger evidence. Open the buyer and use note, then revise your evidence and match.

Evidence trail

The buyer and use note establishes an organisational purpose. The meeting record is consistent with a considered business purchase, but several meetings alone do not establish B2B. The software category alone does not establish it either. Retry by choosing another record or sales structure. After the supported match, continue to the next case.

Compare the cases

Look at who is buying and what the purchase is for. The same shoes were B2C for Jo and B2B for the gym company. The quick café order was B2B; the expensive bicycle chosen over several weeks was B2C. The cloud software supported company operations and was B2B. Speed and price can help describe a sale, but they do not define its structure. Reflect: which record changed or confirmed your tentative match? Explain why it was more useful than the product or pace record. You can reflect privately without entering or submitting anything. Try the cases again to clear all choices and begin at case 1. Reloading also clears your choices.